Hermes Agent Cheat Sheet

01 Start a session (in your terminal)

`hermes`	Start an interactive chat in the current folder.
`hermes -c`	Continue the most recent session. Add a name to pick a different one.
`hermes -r ID`	Resume a session by ID or title. **-r latest** is the same as -c.
`hermes -z "task"`	One-shot: print only the final answer. Good for scripts, but it skips approvals.
`hermes -w`	Work in a separate git worktree so parallel agents don't collide.
`hermes -s name`	Preload one or more skills. Comma-separate several.
`--reasoning high`	Reasoning effort for this run, from none up to ultra.
`--checkpoints`	Snapshot files before destructive edits. **/rollback** restores them.
`hermes --tui`	Use the newer full-screen interface instead of the classic prompt.

02 Setup and upkeep

`hermes setup`	Setup wizard: provider, API key, and model.
`hermes model`	Pick the default model and provider.
`hermes doctor`	Check configuration and dependencies.
`hermes update`	Install the latest version.
`hermes logs -f`	Follow the agent log live. **logs errors** shows only errors.
`hermes --safe-mode`	Start with config, memory, plugins, and MCP servers all off, to rule them out.

03 Keys in a session

`Enter`	Send the message.
`Ctrl+J`	New line. Alt+Enter works too, and Shift+Enter in terminals that support it.
`Tab`	Accept the gray suggestion or complete a slash command.
`Ctrl+C`	Clear what you typed. On an empty prompt, interrupt Hermes. Press twice to quit.
`Esc Esc`	Open the transcript to edit an earlier prompt or fork from it. Same as /rewind.
`Ctrl+G`	Write the prompt in your editor. Save and quit to send it.
`Ctrl+S`	Set the draft aside. Press again on an empty prompt to get it back.
`Ctrl+V`	Paste text and any image on the clipboard. Alt+V pastes just the image.
`Ctrl+T`	Watch running subagents and background processes.
`Ctrl+P`	Fuzzy command palette.
`Ctrl+D`	Exit, on an empty prompt.

04 Add context to a prompt

`@file:path`	Include a file. Add **:10-25** for just those lines.
`@folder:dir`	Include a folder's file tree.
`@diff`	Include your unstaged git changes.
`@url:link`	Fetch a web page into the prompt, as in @url:https://example.com.
`!command`	Run a shell command yourself without spending a model turn.

05 Approvals for risky commands

`manual`	Hermes asks before every dangerous shell command.
`smart`	The default. A second model rates the risk: low-risk commands run, clearly dangerous ones are denied, and the rest ask you.
`off`	No prompts at all. Only for throwaway containers or CI.
`/approvals smart`	Set the mode for good. It is stored as **approvals.mode** in config.yaml.
`/yolo`	Skip every approval in this chat only. **hermes --yolo** does the same at launch.

Habits that save you

Run **/plan** first on anything big. It writes a plan to .hermes/plans/ and changes nothing.
Start with **--checkpoints** in a real repo so **/rollback** has something to restore.
Run **/diff** before you commit, and read it.
Use **/new** or **/compress** between unrelated tasks. Old context costs tokens.
Put API keys in ~/.hermes/.env. **hermes config set** sends secrets there for you.

Watch out

-z one-shot runs and **/yolo** approve everything. Keep them away from production systems.
Hermes reads AGENTS.md and memory files on startup. Check what's in them before you share a repo.

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06 Manage the session

`/new`	Start a fresh session. /reset does the same.
`/retry`	Send your last message again.
`/undo 2`	Back up two of your turns and prompt again. Default is one.
`/rewind`	Edit an earlier prompt and resend it, or fork from it.
`/branch`	Copy this session into a new one to try something else.
`/title name`	Name the session so you can find it later.
`/sessions`	Browse past sessions and resume one.
`/save md file`	Export the conversation as Markdown, JSON, or HTML.
`/quit`	Leave. Add --delete to erase the session history too.

07 Steer it while it works

`/queue text`	Line up a prompt for the next turn. Short form /q.
`/steer text`	Slip in a note after the next tool call without stopping it. Short form /s.
`/btw question`	Ask a side question that doesn't interrupt the task.
`/bg text`	Run a prompt in a separate background session.
`/agents`	Show running agents and tasks.
`/stop`	Kill all background processes.

08 Context and model

`/status`	Session, model, tokens, and context in one view.
`/context`	How full the context window is, and what is filling it.
`/compress`	Summarize older turns to free room. Add **focus topic** to keep one thread. /compact works too.
`/model name`	Switch model for this session. Add **--global** to keep it.
`/reasoning high`	Change reasoning effort, or show and hide the model's reasoning.
`/usage`	Token use and rate limits.

09 Plan, review, and automate

`/init`	Scan the repo and write or update AGENTS.md, the project instructions.
`/plan task`	Write a plan to .hermes/plans/ without running anything.
`/review`	Start a separate subagent to review the work you just discussed.
`/diff`	Show git changes. **/diff session** limits it to this session's edits.
`/rollback`	List or restore file checkpoints.
`/goal text`	Set a goal Hermes keeps working on across turns until it's met.
`/loop 10m text`	Rerun a prompt on a timer in this session.
`/cron`	Manage scheduled tasks that run outside the session.

10 Skills, tools, and memory

`/skills`	Search, install, and manage skills.
`/learn source`	Make a new skill from a folder, URL, notes, or this chat.
`/refine`	Review this chat now and save the lessons to memory and skills.
`/memory pending`	See memory writes waiting for your approval.
`/tools list`	Show tools. **disable** and **enable** turn them off and on.
`hermes mcp`	Add and manage MCP servers. **/reload-mcp** picks up changes.
`/plugins`	List installed plugins and their status.

Where things live

`~/.hermes/config.yaml`: settings. Edit with **hermes config edit**.
`~/.hermes/.env`: API keys, tokens, and other secrets.
`~/.hermes/SOUL.md`: the agent's identity and tone.
`~/.hermes/memories/`: MEMORY.md and USER.md, what Hermes remembers.
`~/.hermes/skills/`: installed skills.
`AGENTS.md`: instructions for one project, in its folder.